LS4: Workspace

Your Workspace

You will spend a lot of time at your workspace. It is important that you feel comfortable talking about it in English to foreign colleagues and clients, including what safety regulations you have to follow and how your company makes sure that its employees stick to different laws and regulations.

1 Match the pictures with the descriptions of the workplaces.

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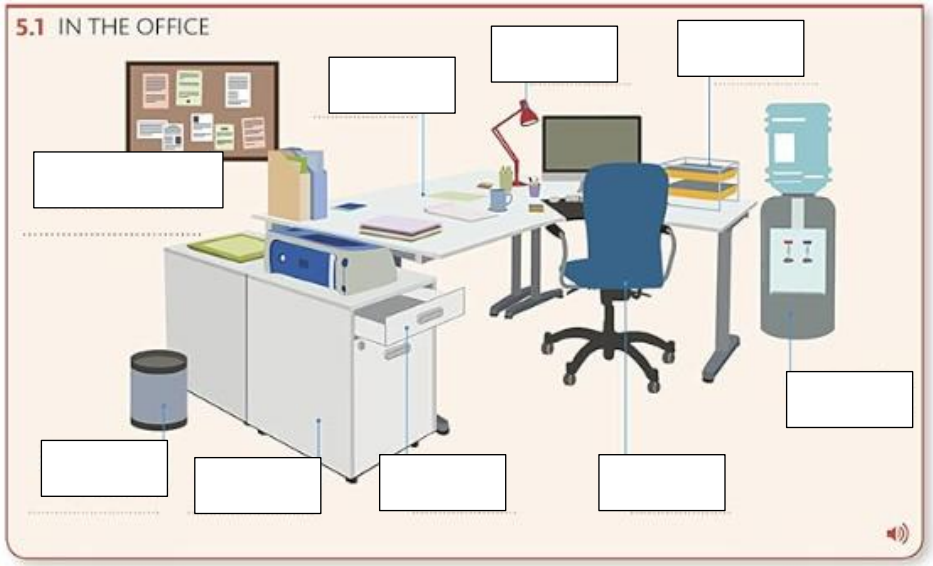
A In a factory, there are lots of tools and machines to work on products. Some machines have fast-moving or sharp parts and might get very hot when in use. Workers must be trained to use the equipment, stick to health-and-safety rules and wear protective clothing.

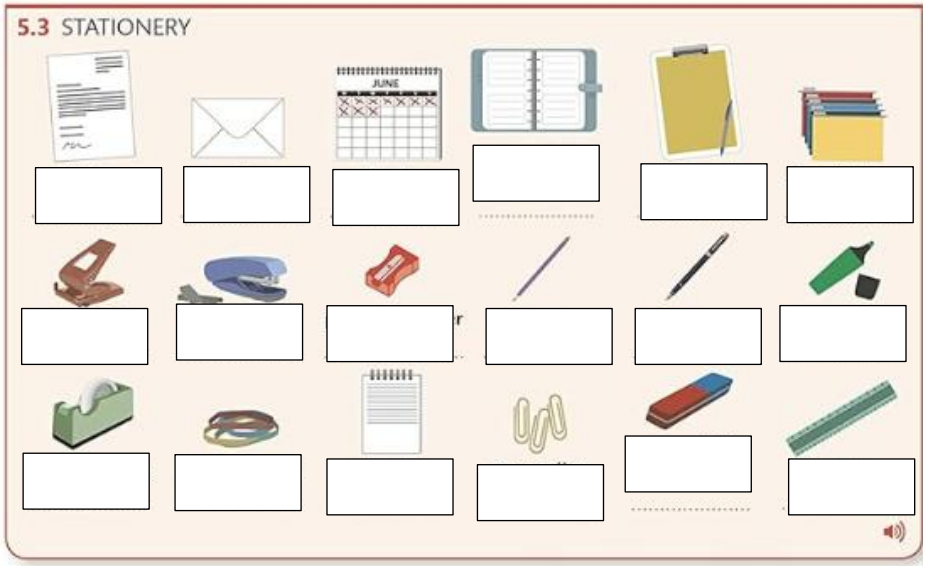
B In many professions, a van is just as important as the tools and equipment it transports. It gets workers to customers to carry out jobs or to suppliers to pick up materials. Items transported in the vehicle must be secured well. A van can usually be driven with a normal driving licence, but extra qualifications might be needed for large-goods vehicles, trailers, etc.

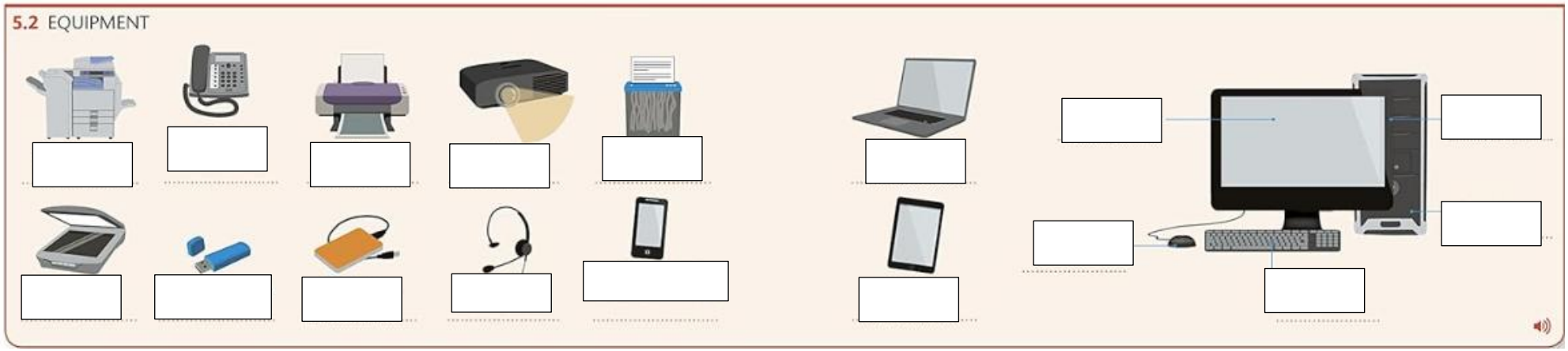
C A workshop has many different items used to work on cars and other vehicles, like spare parts, oils and sprays. There are also special tools and equipment that help workers. Everything should be organised and the workshop floor should be clean and dry.

D Working in IT often means working in an office, server room or even from home. It is important to understand different electronic components, how they communicate with each other and work together in a wider system. All electronic parts must be checked and meet standard certification requirements.

Task 2:
Find the correct words for the office equipment.







Mobile work

Situation

Enis wants to work in a technical job and is researching working conditions. He knows that he will likely have to work irregular hours, sometimes at different locations. He comes across a platform where technical workers talk about their experiences with mobile working.

Experiences of mobile working

Mobile working presents opportunities and challenges for everyone. Four professionals talk to us about their working lives.

Managing customer site visits
by Arthur, field service electronics technician

My job involves visiting different locations to install, maintain, service or repair various electrotechnical systems for smart homes and buildings. Mobile working gives me an exciting working environment and allows me to work closely with customers. One advantage is the freedom to manage my own schedule. But this flexibility comes with responsibilities. I need to make sure that I complete all my tasks on time. I have to handle the reimbursement process for my travel expenses and materials too. So I need to keep careful records and stick to company guidelines.

Weekend and night work
by Deliah, IT professional

In IT, mobile working means more than just working remotely. As I am responsible for system updates and maintenance, I may have to complete critical software updates at weekends or during the night so I don't disturb daily operations. This requires effective communication to make sure everyone is aware of the scheduled maintenance work. It is important to maintain a good work-life balance and find time for personal activities.

Shift work and personal well-being
by Matthias, machine operator

Being a machine operator in a factory often means working shifts to keep production going. For me, mobile working is the ability to move between different sections of the production floor and operate various machines. My work is physically demanding, but the flexibility to change workstations within the facility helps. HR emphasises the importance of a healthy work-life balance. Employees are encouraged to take regular breaks and do physical activities to reduce the stresses of shift work.

On the road to support and assist
by Tuana, roadside mechanic

My company offers roadside assistance and towing services for vehicles that have broken down or been in an accident. I'm also responsible for cleaning up accident sites, like removing harmful chemicals from the road. The roads don't have closing hours, so I have to be available at the weekend and at night too. It's exciting being the first port of call for people in need of assistance. Also, every case is a little bit different, so you never know exactly what to expect. Sometimes it can be frustrating when I can't relax or go to social events because it's my turn to be available. But my team plans the shifts according to a rota, so it's always fair. And in return, I've learned many useful skills and I have great job satisfaction – as well as a company phone!

1 Read the texts. Match each person with the right picture.

Tuana | Matthias | Deliah | Arthur

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2 Read the texts and complete the assignments. Use your own words as much as possible.

1. State one advantage of mobile working for Arthur.
2. Describe Arthur's responsibilities in terms of cost reimbursement.
3. Describe a situation in which Deliah has to work outside of regular working hours.
4. Explain how Deliah makes sure that everyone knows about scheduled maintenance work.
5. List the things Tuana finds exciting about her job.
6. Explain how Tuana's team makes sure the on-call system is fair for everyone.
7. Give one advantage of mobile working for Matthias.
8. Explain how HR supports Matthias in maintaining a healthy work-life balance.

3 Use the information from the text to find at least three advantages and three disadvantages of mobile working.

4 Think about your own job in relation to flexibility and mobility. Do you have any advantages or disadvantages to add?

V10 | I10

5 **Over to you** Managing mobile working → Grammar 8

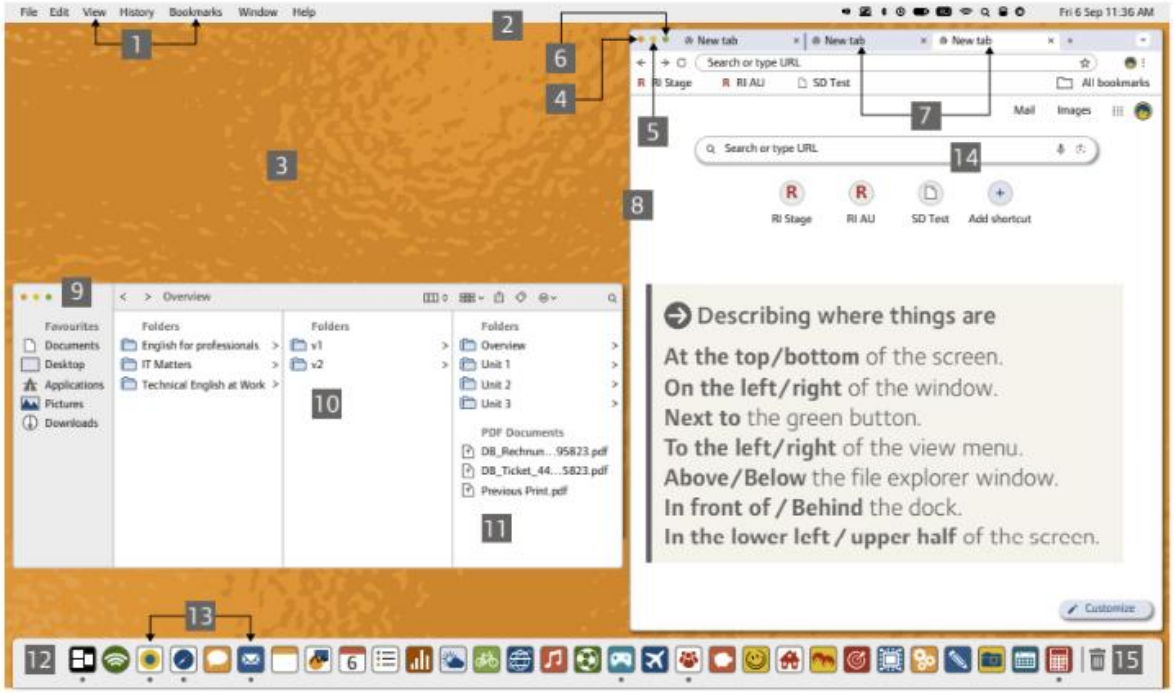
Write a list of three simple, practical time management tips for someone who is new to mobile working. Think about strategies that could help you stay organised and focused.

FOUNDATION: Graphical user interfaces (GUIs)

Situation: You work in the IT Support department of a financial services company in Sydney, Australia.
→ You help a colleague navigate a computer interface.

1 Navigating a desktop or laptop graphical user interface (GUI)

A new employee asks you about a graphical user interface (GUI). It is different to the one he is used to.



A **Match the GUI components from the list to the numbers (1–15) on the screen.**

application icon · application window · close button · desktop · dock · file · file explorer · folder · maximize button · menu bar · menus · minimize button · search bar · tabs · wastepaper basket / trash

B **Describe where each of the GUI components is located on the screen above to help your colleague find them.**

2 Navigating a smartphone GUI

Your team maintain a 'Tips and Tricks' page to help the sales team use the FindYourWay maps app.

FindYourWay – Tips and Tricks — Maps

You can use maps in either portrait or landscape mode by rotating your phone.

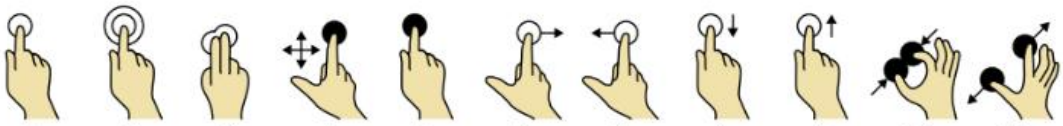
Choose a destination and get directions
- **Press and hold** on the place on the map you want to mark as your destination. A pin will drop onto the map and an address and car symbol will appear.
- **Tap once** on the car symbol and you will be shown a route from your current location to the destination.

Zoom-in
- Place two fingers close together on the screen and then **spread** them to control zoom-in precisely.
- **Double tap** the place you want to zoom into on the screen to zoom in in steps.

Zoom-out
- Place two fingers on the screen and then **pinch** to control zoom precisely.
- Do a **two-finger tap** on the screen to zoom out in steps.

Scroll
- To scroll slowly through a map, touch the screen and **drag** your finger in any direction on the screen.
- To scroll quickly through a map, **swipe up**, **down**, **left or right** through the map.

A **You want to add some icons to the FAQ page to make it easier for some of the non-native employees to understand gestures. Match gestures to each of these icons using phrases from the text.**



1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11

B **Work with a partner. Write a set of English instructions to answer these FAQs using a smartphone that you have. When you have finished, compare your answers with another pair.**

1 How do I delete an app?
2 How do I find a document on my phone?
3 How do I turn on the flashlight?
4 How can I see the widgets?
5 How do I zoom in to a PDF?

› *Useful phrases: Navigating GUIs, page 154*

3 Explaining smartphone functions

A colleague asks you to explain how some of the functions on his new smartphone work.

Work with a partner. Each choose one or two smartphone functions. Write some instructions on how to use the function. Read the instructions to your partner and see whether he/she can perform the function.

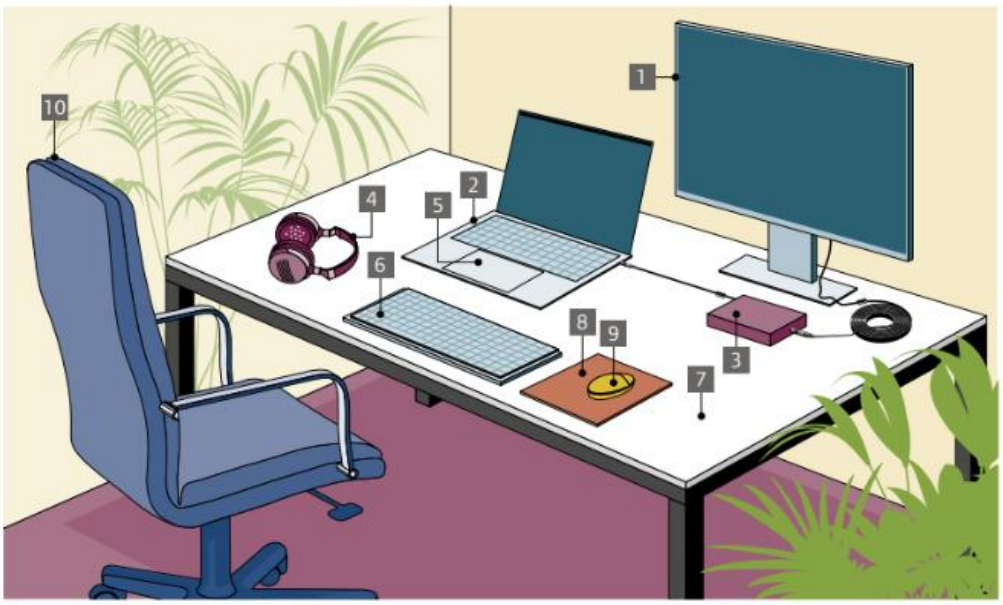
PART A: Hardware set-ups

Situation: You start a job in the IT Support Team at DIY Hardware, a large hardware store chain that operates throughout Canada. Your team supports the employees at DIY Hardware with their computing and workplace.
→ You match a computer to a new colleague's needs.

1 Understanding your workplace

You have your own new workplace set-up.

A **Identify each of the numbered items in the image.**



B **Describe how the desktop in the image compares to your desktop at home, work or school.**

2 Setting up your desktop

You read the instructions on the opposite page on setting up your desktop.

Work with a partner. Take turns asking and answering the following questions about the sample communication. Use suitable verbs from the list in your answers.

connect · ensure · follow · insert · log in · open · place · plug (in) · set · test · turn on

1 What should you do with your laptop after unboxing it?
2 What do you do to log into your laptop for the first time?
3 How do you confirm the docking station is powered?
4 How do you arrange your monitors on your desk?
5 How do you connect your monitors to the docking station?
6 How do you connect a wireless keyboard and mouse to the docking station?
7 What should you do before adjusting the resolution in the display settings?
8 How do you make sure your headset is ready for virtual meetings?

› *Useful phrases: Giving instructions, page 154*

Welcome to the team!

Follow the steps below to set up your workspace using your laptop, two monitors and a docking station.

1 Laptop set-up

- Unbox your laptop and place it on your desk.
- Connect the power cable to your laptop and plug it into a nearby power outlet.
- Power on the laptop by pressing the power button.
- Follow any on-screen instructions to log in using the company credentials provided by IT.

2 Docking station set-up

- Place the docking station on your desk close to your laptop and monitors.
- Connect the dock to your laptop using the appropriate connection (e.g. USB-C).
- Ensure the dock's power adapter is plugged into a power source.
- Confirm that the LED indicator is green.

3 Monitor set-up

- Unbox your two monitors and place them on your desk, side by side, at eye level.
- Connect the monitors to the docking station using HDMI or DisplayPort cables. Each monitor should be connected to a separate video output port on the dock.
- Power on the monitors by pressing their power buttons.

4 Keyboard and mouse set-up

- Connect your keyboard and mouse to the docking station via USB ports.
- If you are using wireless peripherals, insert the USB receiver into the docking station and turn on the keyboard and mouse.
- Arrange the keyboard and mouse in a comfortable position, ensuring your hands and wrists remain neutral while typing or using the mouse.

5 Display configuration

- Once your monitors are connected, your laptop should automatically detect them.
- Open the "Display" settings on your laptop.
- Set the display mode to "Extend", which allows you to use both monitors independently alongside your laptop screen.
- Arrange the monitors in the display settings to match their physical layout on your desk.
- Adjust the resolution to the highest supported option for clear visuals.

6 Headset set-up

- Connect your noise-canceling headset to the dock or pair it if wireless.
- Test the headset's microphone and audio by opening the video meeting software.
- Set it as the default audio device in your system's sound settings for smooth virtual meeting experiences.

7 Webcam set-up

- If your laptop has an integrated webcam, you don't need an external one.
- To check the camera's quality, open a video conferencing app and adjust the angle to ensure your face is clearly visible.

8 Ergonomic chair set-up

- Adjust your ergonomic chair to promote a healthy sitting posture:
  - Set the seat height so that your feet are flat on the floor and your knees are at a 90-degree angle.
  - Adjust the backrest for lumbar support, and slightly recline it for added comfort.
  - Set the armrests at a height where your arms are parallel to the ground while typing, reducing strain on your shoulders.

Final checks

- Ensure that all connections (laptop to dock, dock to monitors, keyboard, mouse) are functioning.
- Confirm that your laptop is charging through the dock.
- Verify that the monitors are displaying as expected, and your workspace is ergonomically comfortable.

If you run into any issues during the set-up process, please contact the IT department for assistance.